

UNIT 4: LIFE ISSUES

Chapter 25: Life Concerns

Comprehensive Course Theory • 40 Active Recall Q&A • Diagnostics Exam • Visual
Data • Memos

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PART 1: EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1. Analytical and Environmental Synthesis

Unit 4 of the official Skills for Life textbook opens with **Life Concerns**, which centers heavily on global ecological imbalance, resource depletion, and human negligence. The lesson explores how industrialization, deforestation, and the excessive burn of fossil fuels have led to irreversible environmental degradation. Students are expected to understand not just the mechanics of climate change, but the moral responsibility of humanity to switch to green lifestyles, lower carbon footprints, and implement eco-friendly policies.

2. Thematic Vocabulary Portfolio

To achieve a high mark on the Baccalaureate, absolute mastery of environmental terminology is non-negotiable. The table below represents the core lexicon of Chapter 25:

Bac Key Word	Definition & Grammatical Nature	Contextual Example / Synonym
Depletion (n.)	The reduction in the quantity or number of something.	The depletion of natural resources forces us to look for alternative energy.
Biodegradable (adj.)	Capable of being decomposed by bacteria or organisms.	We should use biodegradable shopping bags to reduce plastic pollution.
Carbon Footprint (n.)	The amount of carbon dioxide emitted due to consumption.	Switching to public transport is an effective way to lower your carbon footprint.
Eco-friendly (adj.)	Not harmful to the environment; sustainable.	Eco-friendly products help preserve fragile ecosystems.
Fossil Fuels (n.)	Natural fuels (coal, gas) formed from organic remains.	Burning fossil fuels is the primary cause of the greenhouse effect.
To jeopardize (v.)	To put someone or something into danger or risk.	Unchecked carbon emissions jeopardize the survival of future generations.
Greenhouse Effect (n.)	The trapping of the sun's warmth in a planet's lower atmosphere.	The greenhouse effect results in rising global temperatures.

3. Grammar Mastery: Expressing Cause & Effect

Baccalaureate grammar exercises frequently test the syntax of cause and effect. Students must strictly distinguish between connectors followed by a **noun phrase/gerund** and those followed by a **full clause (Subject + Verb)**.

Grammar Function	Key Connectors & Rules	Bac Sentence Structures
Expressing Cause (Phrase)	Because of / Due to / Owing to / As a result of + Noun Phrase / V-ing	Due to the depletion of resources, we must implement recycling laws.
Expressing Cause (Clause)	Because / As / Since / Seeing that + Subject + Verb	We must implement recycling laws because natural resources are depleting.

Grammar Function	Key Connectors & Rules	Bac Sentence Structures
Expressing Effect (Clause)	Consequently / Therefore / As a result / As a consequence / Hence	Industrial activity has increased; consequently, global temperatures are rising.
Expressing Result (Verb)	To lead to / To result in / To cause / To bring about + Noun Phrase	Excessive logging leads to deforestation and severe soil erosion.

4. Phonetics Module: Accentuation & Silent Letters

For oral and spelling skills, the Bac exam evaluates pronunciation patterns. In Chapter 25, the focus is placed on:

- **Word Stress on Nouns ending in '-ity' and '-ment'**: The accent shifts to the syllable preceding the suffix. For instance, cli-mate /'klaɪ.mət/ (1st syllable stress) vs e-col-o-gy /i'kɒl.ə.dʒi/ (2nd syllable) and sus-tain-a-bil-i-ty /sə'steɪ.nə'bɪl.ə.ti/ (stress shifts to 5th syllable).

- **Silent Letters d'examen**: In many environmental terms, certain letters are written but unpronounced (e.g., the silent 'n' in environment /ɪn'vaɪ.rən.mənt/, the silent 'o' in jeopardize /'dʒep.ə.daɪz/, the silent 'a' in breadwinner /'bred.wɪn.ər/).

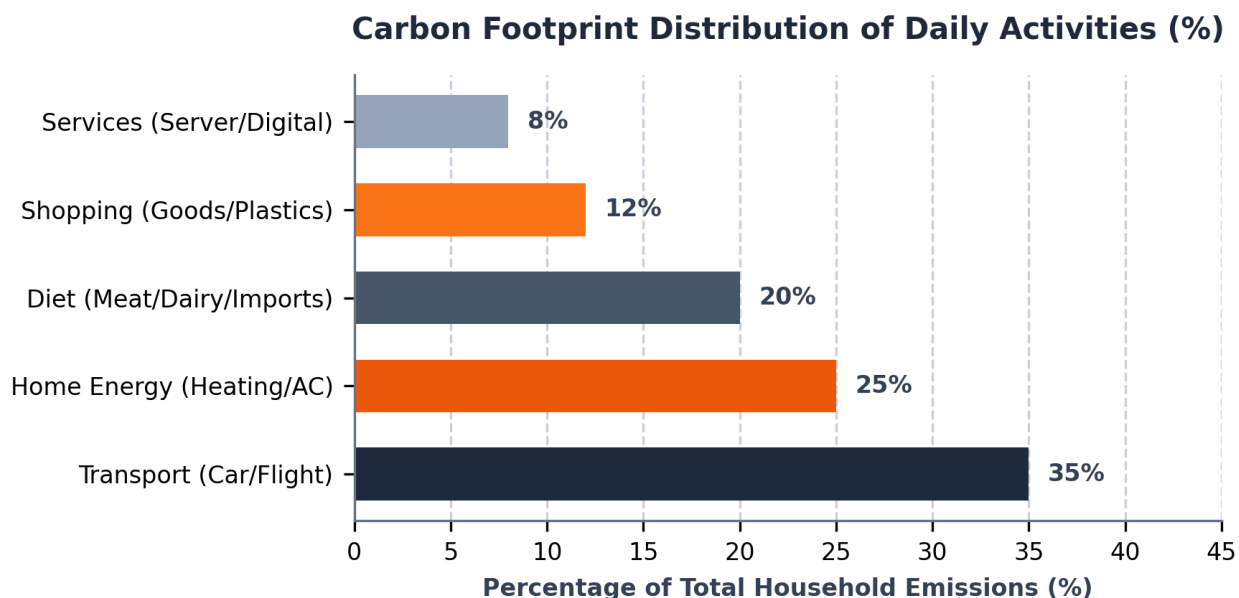


Figure 1.1: Carbon emissions breakdown showing transport and home energy as chief drivers of global warming.

5. Model Argumentative Writing (Bac Theme)

Writing Prompt: Some people believe that individual efforts to protect the environment are useless unless governments take harsh actions. Write a 12-line argumentative paragraph debating this statement.

Although some critics claim that individual efforts are minor, every small action is vital to curb the global ecological imbalance. Due to the continuous burning of fossil fuels, global warming is accelerating at an alarming rate, threatening biodiversity. Consequently, reducing our personal carbon footprint by using public transportation or buying biodegradable products becomes a moral duty. Unless individuals actively adopt eco-friendly habits, governmental policies will fail to bring about sustainable outcomes. For instance, when consumers refuse hazardous single-use plastics, they force giant industries to switch to eco-friendly packaging. In spite of the huge scale of climate change, collective grassroots actions lead to massive positive shifts, proving that the preservation of our fragile planet depends heavily on individual responsibility.

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY

Designed for self-evaluation. Mask the right-hand column to test your knowledge.

Bac Review Question	Model Answer & Grammatical Clues
Q1: What is the core theme of Chapter 25?	It focuses on 'Life Concerns', specifically environmental degradation, resource depletion, climate change, and human moral responsibility.
Q2: What does the term 'depletion' refer to?	The reduction in the quantity or number of something (e.g., natural resource depletion).
Q3: What is the grammatical nature and meaning of 'biodegradable'?	It is an adjective, meaning capable of being decomposed naturally by bacteria or other living organisms.
Q4: Define 'carbon footprint' in environmental terms.	The total amount of greenhouse gases (including carbon dioxide) emitted by our daily activities and consumption.
Q5: Give a synonym for 'eco-friendly'.	Sustainable, non-polluting, green, or environmentally-friendly.
Q6: What are fossil fuels?	Natural fuels such as coal, oil, and gas, formed in the geological past from the remains of living organisms.
Q7: What is the verb meaning 'to threaten or put into danger' used in this chapter?	To jeopardize (e.g., 'jeopardize future generations').
Q8: How does the 'greenhouse effect' work?	It is the trapping of the sun's warmth in the planet's lower atmosphere due to greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide.
Q9: What is the noun form of the verb 'to deplete'?	Depletion.
Q10: What is the noun form of the adjective 'sustainable'?	Sustainability.
Q11: Which preposition always follows the adjective 'accustomed' in Bac exams?	The preposition 'to' (e.g., 'We are accustomed to using plastics').
Q12: Complete the sentence: 'He is dedicated to _____ (protect) the forest.'	'protecting' (gerund form after 'dedicated to').
Q13: Explain the syntax of cause with 'due to'.	It is followed by a Noun Phrase or V-ing (e.g., 'Due to pollution, the air is toxic').
Q14: How does the connector 'because' differ from 'because of'?	'Because' is followed by a full clause (S+V), whereas 'because of' is followed by a noun phrase.

Bac Review Question	Model Answer & Grammatical Clues
Q15: Rewrite using 'Due to': 'We cannot swim because the water is highly polluted.'	'Due to high water pollution, we cannot swim' or 'Due to the water being polluted, we cannot swim.'
Q16: What are three consequence connectors used in writing?	Consequently, therefore, as a result, hence, as a consequence.
Q17: Which verb means 'to result in' or 'to cause'?	To lead to / To bring about / To cause.
Q18: Rewrite: 'Carbon emissions are high, so temperatures are rising.' (Use Consequently)	Carbon emissions are high; consequently, temperatures are rising.
Q19: Explain the grammar rule of 'unless'.	'Unless' means 'if... not'. It introduces a condition, and the verb that follows must be affirmative to avoid double negation.
Q20: Rewrite: 'If we do not stop deforestation, we will suffer.' (Use Unless)	Unless we stop deforestation, we will suffer.
Q21: Is 'unless' followed by a noun phrase or a full clause?	It is followed by a full clause (Subject + Verb).
Q22: Translate into English: 'À cause du réchauffement climatique'.	'Because of global warming' or 'Due to global warming' or 'Owing to global warming'.
Q23: What does 'extinction' refer to in Unit 4?	The dying out or complete disappearance of a species from Earth.
Q24: Which silent letter exists in the word 'environment'?	The silent 'n' (pronounced /ɪn'vaɪ.rən.mənt/).
Q25: Identify the silent letter in 'jeopardize'.	The silent 'o' (pronounced /'dʒep.ə.daɪz/).
Q26: Identify the silent letter in 'hazardous'.	The silent 'o' in the suffix '-ous' /'hæz.ə.dəs/.
Q27: Where does the word stress fall in the noun 'ecology'?	On the second syllable: e-COL-o-gy (/i'kɒl.ə.dʒi/).
Q28: Where does the word stress fall in 'sustainability'?	On the fifth syllable: sus-tain-a-BIL-i-ty (/sə'steɪ.nə'bɪl.ə.ti/).
Q29: What is the stress shift between 'climate' and 'climatology'?	'Climate' is stressed on the 1st syllable; 'climatology' shifts to the 3rd syllable (/ˌklaɪ.mə'tɒl.ə.dʒi/).

Bac Review Question	Model Answer & Grammatical Clues
Q30: Which suffix indicates the noun form of 'hazardous'?	'Hazard' (noun) with suffix '-ous' forms the adjective 'hazardous'.
Q31: Complete: 'If we continue to burn fossil fuels, sea levels _____ (rise).'	'will rise' (First Conditional structure: If + Present Simple, Future Simple).
Q32: Rewrite using 'Unless': 'If governments do not ban plastic, oceans will choke.'	Unless governments ban plastic, oceans will choke.
Q33: What is 'blended learning' in educational technology context?	An educational model that combines online digital media with traditional classroom methods.
Q34: Define the verb 'to transition'.	To undergo a process of change from one state or condition to another.
Q35: What does 'glass ceiling' refer to?	An unacknowledged barrier to advancement in a profession, especially affecting women and minorities.
Q36: Rewrite using 'Despite': 'Although climate change is severe, we can still act.'	Despite the severity of climate change, we can still act (Despite + Noun).
Q37: Explain the pronunciation of the ending '-ed' in 'jeopardized'.	It is pronounced as /d/ because the verb ends with a voiced 'z' sound.
Q38: Explain the pronunciation of the ending '-ed' in 'depleted'.	It is pronounced as /ɪd/ because the verb ends with a 't' sound.
Q39: What is a 'breadwinner'?	A person who earns money to support their family.
Q40: Complete with a collocation: 'We should protect our _____ planet.'	'fragile planet' or 'endangered planet'.

PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ & SUMMARY MEMOS

1. Diagnostic Exam (10 High-Yield Questions)

Test your understanding of Chapter 25. Detailed answers and justifications are provided below.

Q1. Which of the following is followed by a noun phrase or gerund?

- A) Because B) Since C) Due to D) As

Q2. In the word 'environment', which letter is strictly silent?

- A) v B) n C) t D) r

Q3. Fill in the blank: 'We cannot expect to save the forest unless we _____ logging.'

- A) do not stop B) stop C) will stop D) stopping

Q4. Where does the primary word stress fall in 'ecology'?

- A) 1st syllable B) 2nd syllable C) 3rd syllable D) 4th syllable

Q5. Complete: 'She is devoted to _____ green energy.'

- A) use B) using C) used D) uses

Q6. [True/False with justification] Burning fossil fuels has no direct contribution to the greenhouse effect.

Q7. [True/False with justification] The connector 'because of' and 'because' are grammatically interchangeable in any sentence.

Q8. [True/False with justification] The stress of the word 'sustainability' falls on the same syllable as 'sustainable'.

Q9. [True/False with justification] The letter 'o' is silent in the pronunciation of 'jeopardize'.

Q10. [True/False with justification] 'Unless we lower our carbon footprint, global warming will accelerate' is a grammatically correct sentence.

2. In-Depth Correction & Pedagogical Explanations

A1: C (Due to) — Grammatical rule dictates that 'Due to' is a prepositional phrase followed by a noun phrase or V-ing. 'Because', 'Since', and 'As' are subordinating conjunctions followed by full clauses.

A2: B (n) — The first 'n' in 'environment' /ɪn'vaɪ.rən.mənt/ is silent in standard fast pronunciation.

A3: B (stop) — Since 'unless' inherently means 'if not', adding a negative 'do not stop' creates an ungrammatical double negation. Present simple is required in the conditional clause.

A4: B (2nd syllable) — 'ecology' is pronounced /i'kɒl.ə.dʒi/, with primary stress on the second syllable.

A5: B (using) — The collocation 'devoted to' requires the gerund form (V-ing) as 'to' functions here as a preposition, not part of an infinitive.

A6: FALSE — Burning fossil fuels releases massive amounts of greenhouse gases (like carbon dioxide), which directly trap heat in the lower atmosphere, accelerating the greenhouse effect.

A7: FALSE — They are not interchangeable. 'Because' requires a clause (Subject + Verb), whereas 'because of' requires a noun phrase or gerund.

A8: FALSE — In 'sustainable', stress is on the 2nd syllable (sus-TAIN-able). In 'sustainability', stress shifts to the 5th syllable (sus-tain-a-BIL-i-ty) due to the '-ity' suffix rule.

A9: TRUE — 'jeopardize' is pronounced /'dʒep.ə.daɪz/, where the 'o' is completely silent.

A10: TRUE — This is a grammatically flawless First Conditional structure. It uses 'unless' + affirmative present simple, followed by future simple in the main clause.

3. Summary Memo Matrix

Bac Grammar Linkers	Syntactic Formulas & Common Trap Avoidance
Cause Linkers	Because of / Due to / Owing to / As a result of + [Noun Phrase] Common Trap: Never follow these with a verb clause unless you convert it to V-ing (e.g. 'due to his being sick').
Concession Linkers	Although / Even though / Though + [Subject + Verb] Despite / In spite of + [Noun / V-ing] Common Trap: Never write 'despite of' (incorrect mashup of despite and in spite of).
Condition Linkers	Unless + [Affirmative Verb Clause] Common Trap: Avoid double negatives. Do not write 'unless we do not stop...'. Use 'unless we stop...'. So that / In order that + [Subject + Modal + Verb]
Purpose Linkers	In order to / So as to / To + [Base Verb] So that / In order that + [Subject + Modal + Verb] Common Trap: Negative form of 'so as to' is 'so as not to', not 'not so as to'.